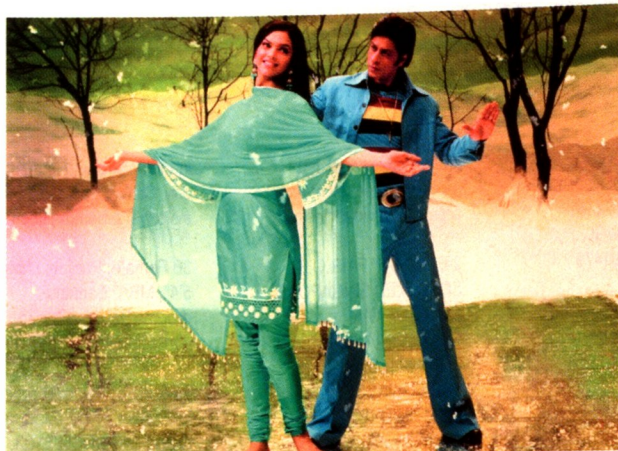


## film reviews Fast Food Fun

**OM SHANTI OM**

**Director:** Farah Khan  
**Starring:** Shah Rukh Khan, Arjun Rampal, Shreyas Talpade and Deepika Padukone

At one point in *Om Shanti Om*, a Hindi film producer advises his director to put a "Manmohan Desai ka angle". "*Woh hi kaam aayega*," he says. Farah Khan obviously agrees. *Om Shanti Om* (OSO) is an unabashed paean to the masala movie in which anything is possible. So a junior artiste who dies just as a superstar's wife is giving birth, is reborn as a superstar; he makes his way to his previous birth-mother without too much fuss and, believe it or not, the climax,



**SOLD ON THE OLD:** Padukone and Shah Rukh Khan

liberally lifted from *Madhumati* and *Karz*, hinges on a door jamming at a critical moment.

But logic, characterisation and consistency aren't what we seek here. We just want a good time and Farah gives us that, at least in the first half of the film. The 1970s OSO is irreverent and funny. But the buoyancy deflates considerably post-inter- val. The screenplay is so

careless, it seems cynical. Like the writing, the actors sparkle in the first half and fumble in the second, though Arjun Rampal makes a superbly slick villain. Finally, despite pounding dance numbers, true blue glamour and some inspired comedy, OSO remains the cinematic equivalent of fast food—it's fun but entirely forgettable.

by Anupama Chopra

## Song Sung Blue

**SAAWARIYA**

**Director:** Sanjay Leela Bhansali  
**Starring:** Ranbir Kapoor, Sonam Kapoor

A mysterious girl traipses around a timeless town's shadowy alleys waiting for her true love to return. A lonesome boy turns cartwheels like *Life is Beautiful*'s Roberto Benigni, hoping to win her heart. Occasionally, there's a flash of her ankles like *Pakeezah*'s Meena Kumari and then again there's a glimpse of his butt as his towel drops like *Bobby*'s Rishi Kapoor. He yearns for her and she loves another in what Sanjay Leela Bhansali thought was a classic romance told in



**WHERE THE PROPS ARE THE STARS:** Ranbir and Sonam

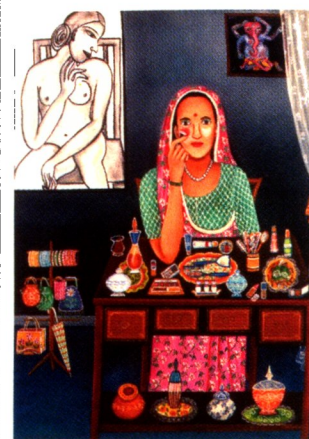
Broadway musical style but executed, incorrectly, on motion picture. *Saawariya*, like all of Bhansali's works, is imbued with the sub-text of movies past, and serves as a quiz to beginners (quick, which film is the umbrella-in-the-rain scene a tribute to?). But like the dazzlingly-designed, blue-green-hued 12 sets on

which the movie plays out, much of the emotions seem as artificial as the props. Add a plodding plot, inertia-laden dialogue, and too much doffing of the hat to Raj Kapoor and you have less of a film and more of a look-at-me showreel for the talented Ranbir Kapoor and Sonam Kapoor. Picture *abhi baki hai*.

by Kaveree Bamzai

## art August Company

**MUMBAI** Gauging the meaning of an art work is something we indulge in often. And then there are the deliberations on the artist's thoughts while painting. So here's an artist who delves into the psychological and socio-economic conditions that prompt artists to paint



**Kanodia's work with iconic image of Chowdhury's work**

what they did. Nayanaa Kanodia borrows from the themes and experiences of master contemporary artists and converts them into art works that are unique in aspect and creativity.

Kanodia approaches the history of art in a spirit of playful homage. In her recent paintings, she engages with the iconic images of Picasso, Matisse, Modigliani, M.F. Husain, Jogen Chowdhury, Jehangir Sabavala, among others, injecting their energy into her own work; a quirky tableaux drawn from everyday life. Distinguished Company, a collection of around 30 paintings by Kanodia, is available for view at Jehangir Art Gallery from November 19 to 26.

by Swati Mathur